a bilateral level with SADC countries, we need our own bank … The name of the DBSA is misleading, as it was established by the apartheid government that saw Southern Africa as consisting of apartheid South Africa and the former homelands.' After leaving his job, Caholo renewed his criticism in October 2013, arguing that the DBSA 'only exists in name', while in contrast, 'A regional bank is supposed to have regional representation of all SADC member states, or at least the participating members in the governance structure. This is still not the case for DBSA.'

Just as it was deployed to become Pretoria's core representative as the BRICS Bank was being conceptualised, the DBSA fell into disrepute within South Africa for recording R430 million in net losses in 2011–12, based on (unspecified) investments. In late 2012, the new DBSA CEO, Patrick Dlamini, announced a 'new restructuring process, staff would be retrenched [from 750 to 300] and corruption would not be tolerated. We can no longer allow the DBSA to be associated with shoddy work.' Dlamini's prior job was as an executive with the Air Traffic and Navigation Services company, and he had no prior development finance experience.

In late 2013, the complaints and confessions were the same. In the *Sunday Times,* Chris Barron interviewed Dlamini: 'We have huge room for improvement. Our job is to fund infrastructure development at municipal level, but if you look at this space you see a serious collapse of infrastructure.' His own infrastructure had also collapsed, for Barron's sources noted 'the departure of staff members with valuable information technology, project management and other skills … [who] have been snapped up by the big commercial banks, which will be competing with the DBSA to provide infrastructure funding.' As Barron noted, 'Hard-earned taxpayers' money was invested in Sol Kerzner's One&Only hotel … It lost a fortune on five-star luxury hotels, platinum jewellery and other such projects instead of investing it in boring things like water-treatment plants, roads, schools and hospitals.' The loan and investment amounted to nearly R3.2 billion, or 7% of the portfolio.

Yet in addition to managers of inappropriate investments, the entire social and environmental division was dismissed, including leadership of an important Green fund to promote employment. Moreover, as Carol Paton of *Business Day* remarked in 2013, 'When it comes to project work, the bank will be in the same position as most state departments: it will need to put out to tender. There is also another problem. The business model of the bank remains tenuous … it does not take deposits and so does not have a source of cheap money, the capital injection provided for in this year's budget being a rare event.'